

A HOLY CITY

Machu Picchu is a religious center. It has four temples, the most important of which is the Temple of the Sun, where the sun god Inti is worshipped. The Inca believed that the emperor was descended from Inti—perhaps that's why the royal family spends so much time in this holy city.



There are over
150 buildings
in the city of
Machu Picchu.



Geometric patterns decorate this tunic. The most valuable cloths were given as gifts or worn by high-status people.

Colorful clothing

The Inca used the wool of llamas, alpacas, and vicuñas to weave cloth. Their cloth was colorful, with beautiful, elaborate patterns. This is known because Inca textiles were preserved by the dry, cold climate of the Andes.

Temple

This sacred building has no roof and is open to the elements on one side. It was built from stones that were cut to fit perfectly, with no mortar needed to hold them together.

Mamakuna are women who sing and play drums at ceremonies. They are chosen as children and live in the temple while they are trained.

This is a golden likeness of Inti, the sun god.

Music is an important part of Inca rituals. The instruments were usually played by women.

Brave soldiers sometimes receive rewards of gold from the emperor.

The Inca emperor only wears his *uncu* (a piece of clothing) once. Every day he burns the worn *uncu* in a special ceremony.

